

Introduction to Audacity

Learning Objectives

- Identify Audacity as a free audio editing tool
- Navigate the Audacity interface and key controls
- Record and play back a short audio clip

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Think of a radio jockey who trims songs, adds effects, and mixes voices before broadcasting. Audacity lets you do the same on a computer—for free. Today we meet this powerful audio editing tool.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Open Audacity on the computer. Explore the toolbar—find the record button, play button, pause, and stop. Click around (but don't save anything) to see what each button does. Write the name and purpose of three buttons you discover.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Audacity is free, open-source software for recording and editing audio. Its interface has a timeline where audio waves appear, transport controls for play/record/stop, and toolbars for effects and editing. Think of it as a digital tape recorder you can cut and modify.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Record yourself saying a five-word sentence about your village. Play it back and observe the waveform that appears. Identify which parts are loud and which are quiet by looking at the wave heights. Write your observations.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Name three buttons in Audacity and their functions. Explain what a waveform represents in Audacity.